

WOC project – Please Don*t Panic

Mental health brand identity and design through product design, product management, and brand design.

About the brand and the idea behind it-

Please Don*t Panic is a brand that has been created to break the stigma that mental health is a sensitive topic that must be tread lightly around. Often people with mental illnesses fear coming out to their peers, family or society itself that they are facing issues mentally or emotionally, due to the fear of being treated differently by the people they love or excluded due to the illnesses they face. According to the World Health Organization (WHO), one in four people face mental illnesses, yet it is still being treated like a taboo subject. As an individual with depression, I have personally faced this issue and delayed telling my parents about it with the fear of being treated differently.

The only way to combat this stigma against mental illness is through exposure and showing people that it is a normal thing to face and is natural. Thus, the idea of Please Don*t Panic is to create a symbol of identity and support for people facing mental illness by normalizing and integrating it into our culture. This could be done via several means such as streetwear and fashion or merchandise as a means to blend it into the daily lives of the users.

This is mental health without the whisper. A modern, human-centric identity that blends boldness with calm, style with sincerity. The brand stands at the intersection of self-expression and self-care, transforming mental wellness from a taboo topic into a design language people are proud to wear, display, and live with.

Design-wise, the brand embraces a minimal yet commanding visual presence.

The logo and wordmark design-

Brand Identity

The brand challenges the outdated assumption that mental health must be approached with hushed tones, fragile language, or overly-clinical jargon. Instead, it reimagines mental wellness as something powerful, expressive, and culturally relevant.

Target Audience:

Mental health is not a niche. it's a universal human condition that transcends demographics. Your brand doesn't aim for age groups, psychographics, or tribes, it

speaks to humanity as a whole . The products become a subtle symbol of allyship and awareness. They are carried not just for style, but as a quiet declaration that mental health matters. People can signal empathy, solidarity, and openness without needing to say a single word.

Thought Process:

The brand's visual philosophy follows one guiding principle: stable can be stylish.

The goal was to design a logo and wordmark that felt grounded, almost meditative, yet instantly recognizable. It avoids chaotic forms or overly expressive marks, maintaining a static composure that calms the eye and steadies the mind.

**PLEASE
DON*T
PANIC®**

Fig 1.1-final wordmark

A simply bold wordmark that reminds both the user and passersby of a simple yet important action of not panicking when times get tough. It is to signal to those with anxiety, depression or any other mental illness that 'don't panic, we support you and who you are in a subtle manner. Easily readable and bold as a means of spreading the message effectively and stylishly as the brand identity suggest.

**PLEASE
DON*T
PANIC®**

**PLEASE
DON*T
PANIC®**

**PLEASE
DON*T
PANIC®**

Fig 1.2- initial wordmark iterations

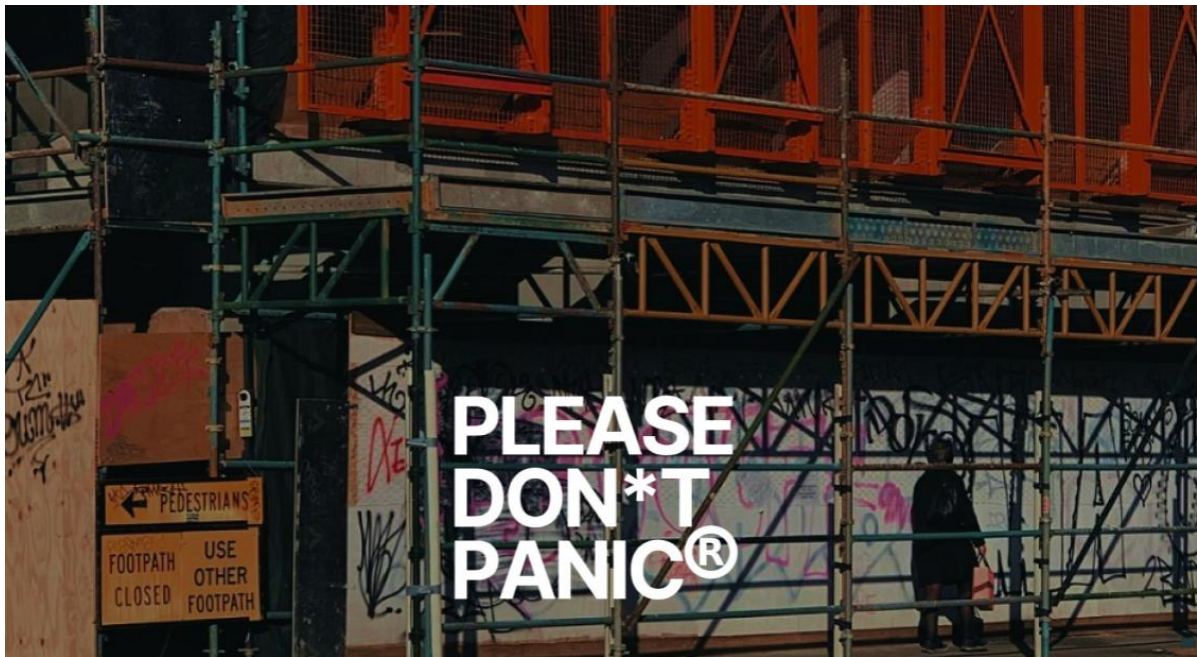


Fig 1.3- use of wordmark in branding

Nevertheless, the logo must stick to the brand identity as well by retaining the bold and stark elements of the wordmark. The stable nature of the logo will further imply stability and strength.



Fig 1.4- visual behind the final logo

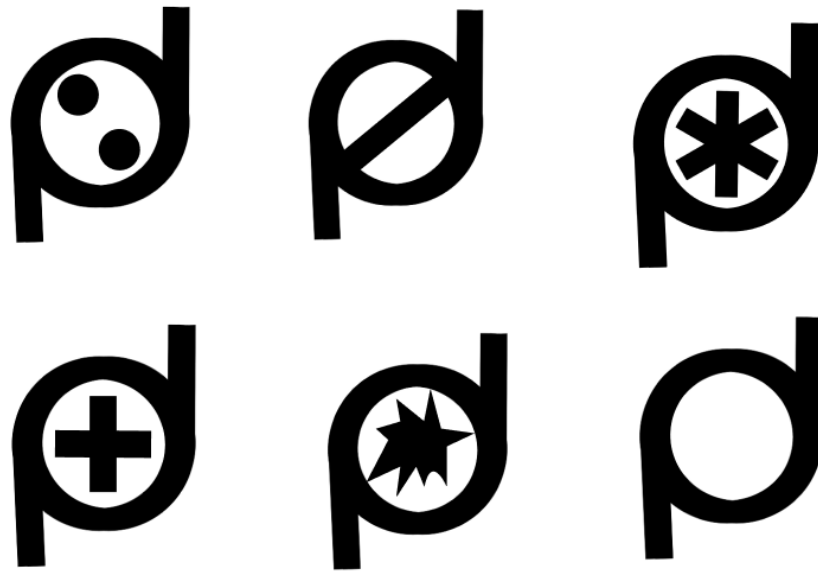


Fig 1.5- initial iterations of logo



Fig 1.6- final logo

This is mental health without the whisper. It is created via the starting letters of 'Please Don*t Panic' and includes the 'don't' aspect via the slant line within the logo. Furthermore, the composition reflects ideas such as Yin and Yang as well as the mind's eye- all symbols of peace, calm and wisdom. The logos cyclical symmetry allows for visual harmony and the star in the centre draws the viewers' attention towards the logo.

Product selection and design-

Product selection for 'Please Don't Panic'-

The products I shortlisted are unique to different mental illnesses that are commonly faced by many people. They seek to aid or solve parts of the problems faced by individuals facing mental illnesses such as OCD, depression and anxiety. The aim of the products is to become an everyday tool for the user, serving both a core function as well as holding the brand's message with the product.

Specialised Toolset

- Tools = control, preparedness, and competence
- Common with OCD or anxiety where being "ready" reduces mental noise
- Physical objects help externalize internal chaos
- Ritual use provides grounding and reassurance.

Pill Organizer

- Structure reduces cognitive load during depression
- Visual order = mental order
- Helps people regain routine when days blur together
- Reinforces self-care as a daily, manageable act

Helmet / Mask

- Creates a sense of safety and separation from an overwhelming outside world
- Acts as a personal boundary for people with anxiety or paranoia
- Helps some feel anonymous, protected, or less perceived/judged
- Symbolizes "I control what gets in"

Headphone Covers

- Sound control is crucial for sensory overload and anxiety
- Covers personalize and soften harsh stimuli
- Creates a safe auditory bubble
- Signals "do not disturb" without confrontation

Spray Bottle

- Spraying = instant feedback + relief
- Used in grounding, cleaning, or calming rituals
- The act itself is repetitive, controlled, and soothing
- Gives the feeling of “resetting” a space or moment

Essential Oil Diffuser

- Smell is directly linked to memory and emotion
- Creates a predictable, calming environment
- Helps regulate mood during anxiety or depressive episodes
- Becomes a sensory anchor during distress

The final product that was selected was the headphone covers due to their easy user interface and mass appeal while still managing to comply with brand ideals. They act as a barrier from sensory overload and imply protection and space. The headphone covers will also be paired with a suit of protective covers such as an iPhone cover and an iPad cover. This broadens the user demographic and the number of people willing to buy a product from the brand.

The headphone covers should be bold and simply as the brand identity suggests while keeping a balance between unique and innovative and functional. It must be the ideal mix of standing out while remaining simple. This paired with logo integration in the product led to the following ideations.



Fig 2.1- ideation sketches



Fig 2.2- working of the headphone clip-ons

The final silhouette that we landed on was abstract version of the logo with an organic feel that felt that the extension grew onto the headphone, much like a symbiote clinging onto a host. This is a metaphor for many mental illnesses such as depression and OCD- that often cling onto the host their entire life waiting to consume them when they are at their weakest.



Fig 2.3- final silhouette of the headphone covers

To model a 3d version of the headphone cover software's such as Nomadsculpt and Blender were used. This allowed for accurate creation of a scaled version of the product while still giving creative freedom to user during the modelling process as well.

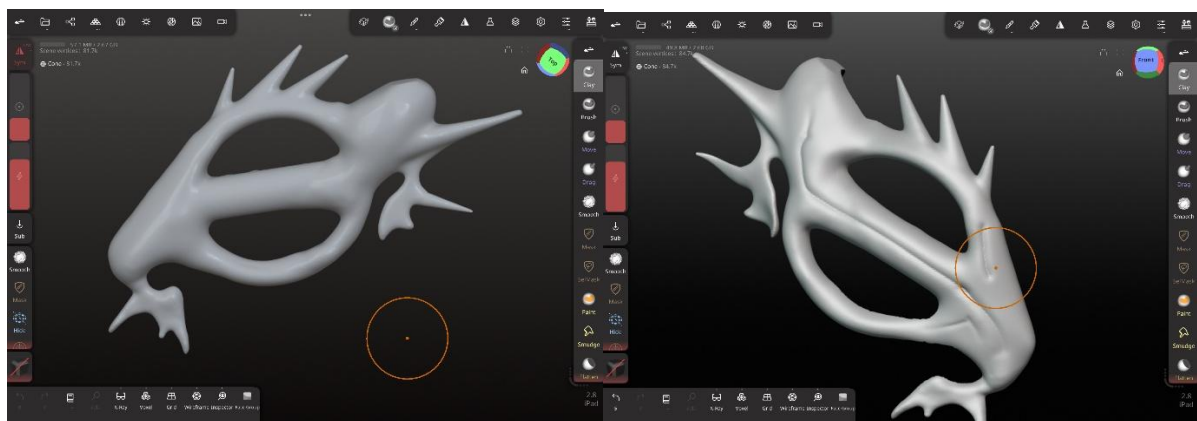


Fig 2.4- process pictures during modelling of headphone cover

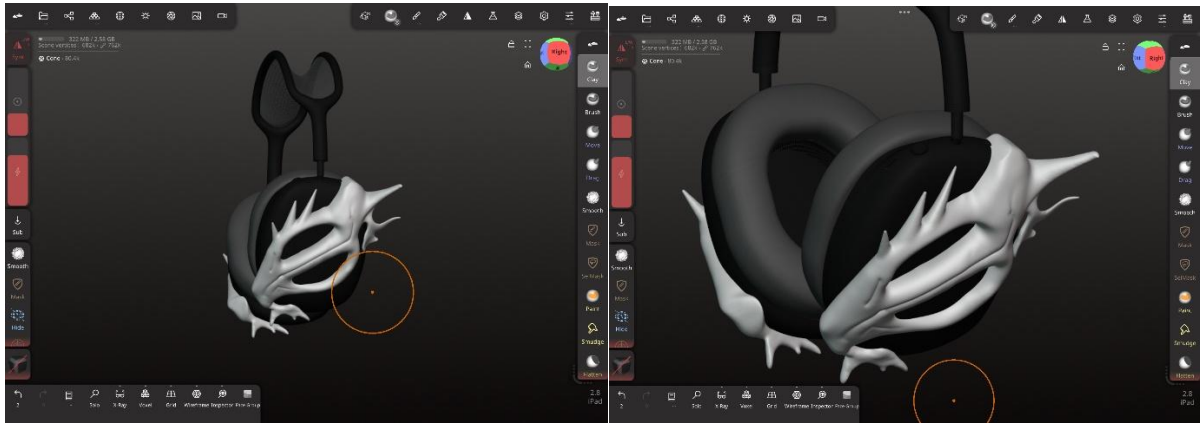


Fig 2.5- process pictures during modelling of headphone cover onto headphones

The initial material finish for the headphone covers selected was a metallic variant that reflected the ongoing trend of cyber sigilism (a niche, futuristic tattoo and art style blending abstract, sharp sigils (intention symbols) with digital, often chrome or glitchy, metallic aesthetics)



Fig 2.6- rendered headphone cover using cyber sigilism aesthetic



Fig 2.7- rendered headphone cover onto headphone itself



Fig 2.8- poster design iterations for the product

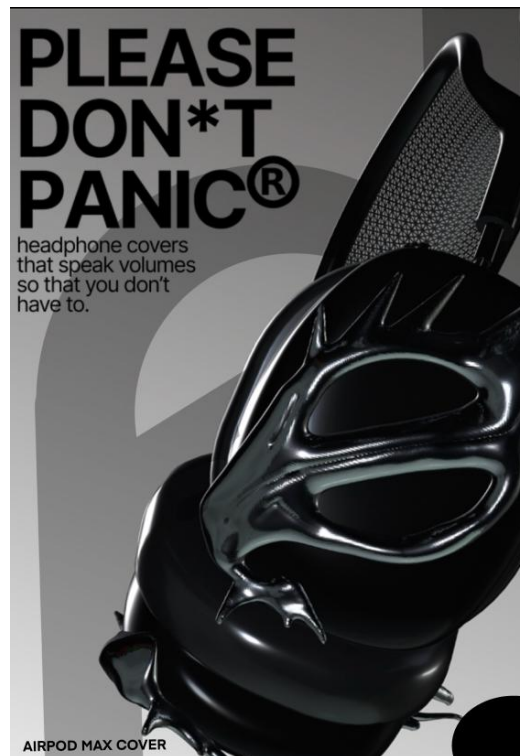


Fig 2.9- final product cover poster design

However, the problem that arises is that the message is lost in loud flashiness of the product. As a brand that stands for simplicity and boldness, the inclusion of a metallic texture gives the feel of an 'edgy rock band' rather than a brand that emphasizes empathy and transparency. Furthermore, the material itself doesn't contain any quality that support brand ideals thus, we decided to switch to more suitable materials.

The use of sensory materials in industrial design is a growing trend that identifies materials that help neurodivergent people adapt and provide comfort through tactile means. Grounded in neuroscience, ergonomics, and CMF (Colour–Material–Finish) practice. In industrial design Sensory comfort materials reduce cognitive load and nervous-system activation through predictable touch low irritation-controlled friction thermal neutrality acoustic dampening.

They're especially effective for anxiety, OCD, ADHD, depression, and sensory sensitivity, but also improve baseline product usability for everyone.

- Soft-Touch Polymers (Controlled Tactility) Materials
- TPU (Thermoplastic Polyurethane)
- TPE
- Silicone elastomers (medical / food grade)

Apples Liquid glass is a good example of digital sensory material, that is meant to provide a smooth user experience that reduces cognitive load.

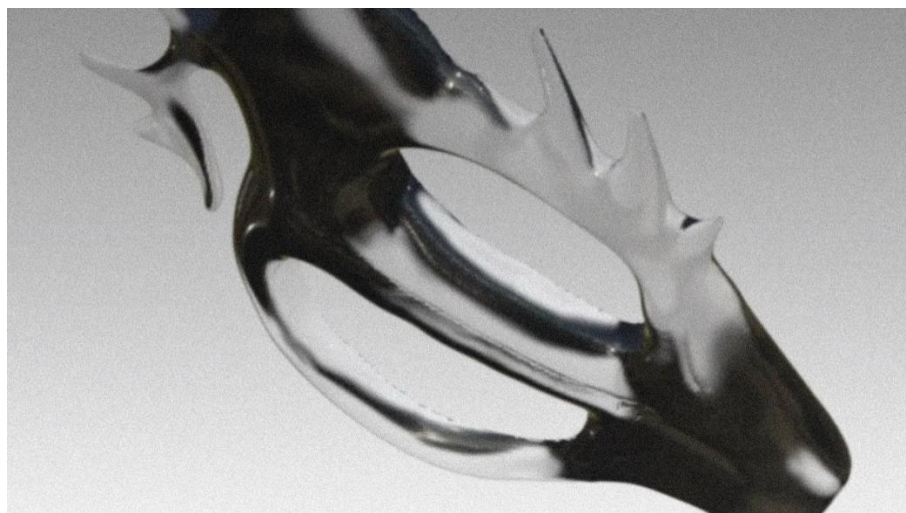
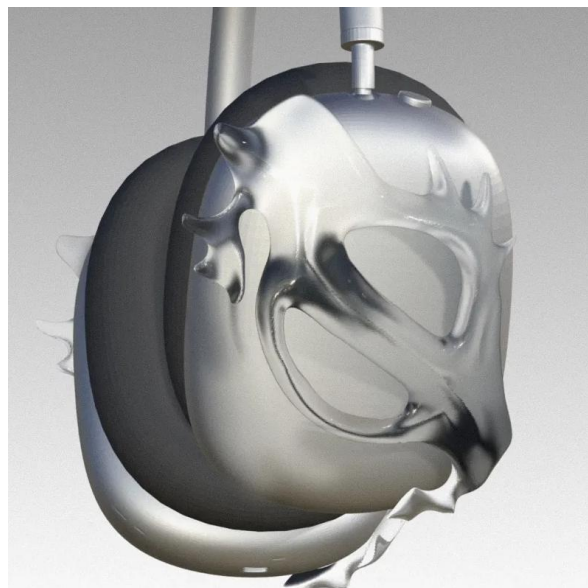
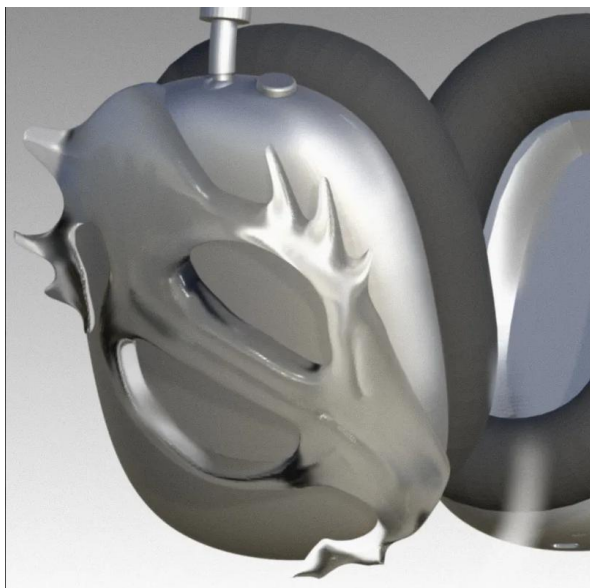


Fig 2.10- sensory comfort silicone headphone covers

With the conclusion of the design of the headphone cover, a standard for the next products that were to be designed under the brand merchandise umbrella are set. The following products must be organic while also being simple and bold as well. Furthermore, the headphone cover is a niche product that not many people use or are aware of, it mostly serves as a standout product that is unique and not found in many other brand merchandise.

However, in the selection there must also be products that are more common and appeal to a larger demographic. Thus, the next products to be designed for 'Please Don*t Panic', will be an iPhone cover and an iPad cover.

Much like the headphone covers the iPhone and iPad covers should be bold and simple as the brand identity suggests while keeping a balance between unique and innovative and functional. It must be the ideal mix of standing out while remaining minimal. It should also integrate the logo not the design as well. Keeping all of this in mind the following designs were created.



Fig 2.11- iPhone and iPad silhouettes

The following designs are based on exoskeleton covers. These are popular for their minimal use of material while still maintaining the same level of protection for the device. This is done via padding the edges of the device very well along with padding on the flat back surface for the phone to not be in direct contact with any surface when resting. The covers also follow the same symbiotic elements as the headphone cover to further stick to the message of the covers. Mental illness both can be a barrier from the outside world as well as a symbiote feeding on one's psyche simultaneously.

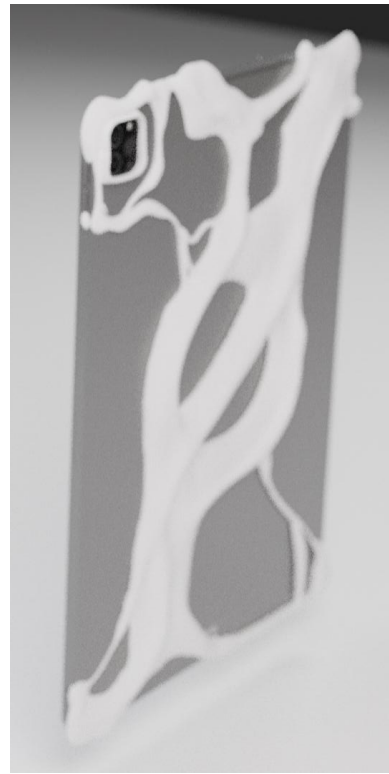


Fig 2.12- iPad cover render



Fig 2.13- iPhone cover render

Final Renders of all the products-

Renders that show a product within a background are more effective because they provide context, scale, and emotional meaning. A background helps the viewer instantly understand where, how, and why the product exists, reducing cognitive effort. Instead of imagining a use case, the user sees it.

Contextual environments also trigger emotional association, lighting, setting, and surrounding elements communicate mood, lifestyle, and brand values far more efficiently than the product alone. This makes the product feel real rather than abstract.

From a perception standpoint, backgrounds improve depth, contrast, and hierarchy, guiding the eye and increasing visual engagement. Pure product renders are ideal for technical clarity, but product-in-environment renders are better at storytelling, memorability, and persuasion—which is ultimately what drives interest and desire.





